January, 1967 removed the timeline of 1 January, 1951. It also stated that the present Protocol should apply without any geographic limitation as the 1951 Convention by “events occurring before 1 January, 1951” referred to events occurring in Europe and elsewhere.

Some important clauses of the 1951 Convention are given below:

As refugees more often enter a territory without lawful documents and permission to enter the territory, the Contracting States were directed not to impose penalties, on account of their illegal entry or presence. This is because they enter their territory directly from a territory where their life or freedom was threatened as given in Article 1 of the Convention. [Article 31]

The Contracting States should not expel a refugee lawful in their territory other than grounds of national security or public order. [Article 32]

The most significant feature of the 1951 Convention is the principle of non-refoulement. [Article 33 (1)]. No refugee shall be expelled or returned (“refouler”) to the frontiers of the territories where that person’s life is threatened by the reason’s mentioned in the Convention.

A few other human rights documents which are applicable in case of refugees are given below:

- Universal Declaration of Human Rights, 1948
- International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights, 1966
- International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, 1966
- The UN Declarations on Territorial Asylum, 1967
- Convention on the Rights of the Child, 1989
- Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women, 1981
- Convention Against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment, 1984
- The International Convention on the Protection of the Rights of All Migrant Workers and Members of Families.